

Transforming Technical Documentation into eLearning: A User Education Strategy for Technical Build Processes

Project Overview

Objective: Enable users with limited technical experience to successfully build and install the AAPS application using the GitHub Browser Build process.

Audience: New and existing AAPS users ranging from highly technical community members to individuals with little software development experience.

Role: Learning Experience Designer, eLearning Developer, Community Adoption Lead

Tools: OpenLMS | GitHub | Facebook

View Live Project:

Fully edited and published OpenLMS version: <https://aapsguide.github.io/>

Portfolio Note: This project was created for an open-source software community supporting users of the AndroidAPS application. Community standards require instructional content to be text-based and prohibit audio narration, creating a unique instructional design constraint.

Business Challenge

The AAPS community had already developed comprehensive documentation explaining how to build the application using the GitHub Browser Build process. However, the documentation was written as a technical reference rather than a guided learning experience.

As a result, many users, particularly those with limited technical experience, struggled to complete the build process successfully. Volunteer support channels on Facebook and Discord received a high volume of repetitive build-related questions, and many existing users continued using older, more complex build methods because they were more familiar with them.

This resulted in:

- High demand on volunteer support resources
- Repetitive troubleshooting questions in community forums
- Low confidence among new users attempting the build process
- Continued use of outdated and less efficient build methods

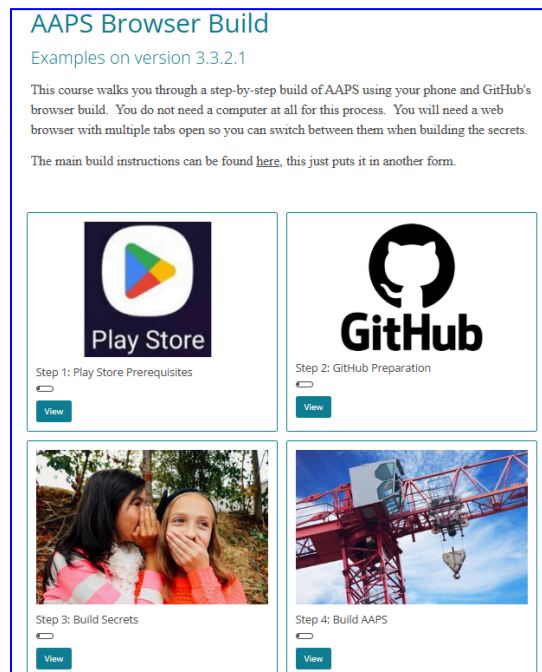
The community needed a learner-friendly experience that could translate complex technical documentation into a structured, step-by-step process that users could confidently follow independently.

Approach

Analysis of the existing documentation revealed several points where users commonly became confused or abandoned the process. Because community standards prohibited audio narration, the learning experience relied heavily on visual guidance, progressive disclosure of information, and step-by-step instruction.

To support learners with different experience levels, I organized content into logical stages and incorporated branching pathways that allowed users to navigate directly to the build process relevant to their needs.

Screenshot 1: AAPS Browser Build homepage with clear progression through the course.



Screenshot 2: Branching to address different types of users with different build needs.

Prior Use

Do you have prior experience using AAPS?

If you answer **Yes** you **MUST** know how to find your `.jks` file and know its password, its alias (usually `key0`), and its alias password (usually the same as the JKS password).

If you do not have this information then you must answer **No** here.

If you answer **No** then you will not be able to install this build over your current build. If you are currently using AAPS and answer **No**, be sure to export and save your preferences from your current AAPS to a place where you will be able to access them after installing the new version.

Choose one option. Then select **Submit Answer**. Then select **Continue** and scroll down.

☐ Yes

☐ No

Submit Answer

Solution

Challenge: Technical documentation functioned as a reference guide rather than a learning experience.

Design Response: Created a structured eLearning experience that transformed technical instructions into a guided, step-by-step learning journey to inspire user confidence.

Key Features:

- Text-based instruction aligned with community standards
- Visual guidance and screenshots
- Branching navigation
- Logical progression through the build process

Impact

User Experience

- Created a learner-centered resource that guided users through the build process.
- Allowed users to quickly locate information relevant to their build scenario.
- Enabled existing users to transition to the newer GitHub Browser Build method.
- Reduced the intimidation factor associated with technical documentation.

Community Operational Impact

- Provided volunteers with a structured learning resource they could share.
- Decreased repetitive build questions.
- Shifted community conversations toward advanced product usage and optimization.

Key Learning & Reflection

This project reinforced that accurate documentation is not the same as effective instruction. While the original documentation contained all of the information users needed, many learners struggled because the information was organized as a technical reference rather than a guided experience.

By restructuring the content into a learner-centered format, I was able to reduce cognitive load, improve navigation, and create a resource that better supported users with varying levels of technical experience.

Skills Demonstrated

- | | |
|------------------------------|----------------------------|
| • Instructional Design | • Information Architecture |
| • eLearning Development | • User Education |
| • Learning Experience Design | • Content Strategy |
| • Technical Communication | • Community Enablement |